

RICHMOND AGITATION-SEDATION SCALE (RASS)

Targeted Titration of Sedation and Agitation in Critical Care

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

TEN SEDATION-AGITATION LEVELS

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
+4: Combative Violent behavior	☐ Overtly combative or violent; immediate danger to staff safety. (4)	[]
+3: Very Agitated Aggressive behavior	☐ Pulls on or removes endotracheal tubes or intravenous catheters; aggressive. (3)	[]
+2: Agitated Non-purposeful movement	☐ Frequent non-purposeful movement or patient-ventilator dyssynchrony. (2)	[]
+1: Restless Apprehensive / anxious	☐ Anxious or apprehensive but movements not aggressive or vigorous. (1)	[]
0: Alert and Calm Target baseline state	☐ Spontaneously alert, calm, attends to examiner. (0)	[]
-1: Drowsy Slight sedation	☐ Not fully alert, but has sustained awakening (eye-opening/contact to voice $\geq$ 10s). (-1)	[]
-2: Light Sedation Brief eye contact	☐ Briefly awakens with eye contact to voice (< 10 seconds). (-2)	[]
-3: Moderate Sedation Movement to voice	☐ Any movement (eye opening or limb motion) to voice, but no eye contact. (-3)	[]
-4: Deep Sedation Physical stimulation only	☐ No response to voice, but any movement to physical stimulation (shoulder shake). (-4)	[]
-5: Unarousable No response to pain	☐ No response to voice or physical stimulation (sternal rub / nailbed pressure). (-5)	[]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 10 levels (-5 to +4))

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Agitated State (+1 to +4) (+1 to +4)

Assess pain (BPS/CPOT), assess delirium (CAM-ICU), treat cause.

Target Sedation (0 to -1) (0 to -1)

Ideal target for most awake, spontaneously ventilating ICU patients.

Moderate Sedation (-2 to -3) (-2 to -3)

Target for acute mechanical ventilator dyssynchrony or prone position.

Deep Sedation (-4 to -5) (-4 to -5)

Perform daily spontaneous awakening trial (SAT) unless contraindicated.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment